

Individual Reflection Report

Group Working Style and Contribution

Our group (Friday 10 am Group 23) worked collaboratively through both online chat platforms and in-person meetings. We first discussed the project scope and divided tasks clearly, maintaining regular communication to ensure progress and consistency.

Yunbin Yan focused on gathering background information, drafting several sections of the report, and analysing Japan's fiscal and monetary policy framework. He also contributed to the presentation script.

I, Zhiqi Fang, was mainly responsible for the data processing, cleaning, and visualization using data obtained from the World Bank Database. Using R (including ggplot2 and related packages), I created the graphs and charts used in Sections A, B. I also designed and edited the PowerPoint slides and other visual materials used in the video presentation. In addition, I worked extensively on refining, restructuring, and polishing the written report, ensuring that it met both academic and formatting requirements.

Throughout the process, I used ChatGPT to develop ideas for the Section B graph and improve its design, while DeepSeek and ChatGPT supported literature search, summarization, and language refinement. These AI tools helped integrate theoretical insights more effectively and enhanced the clarity and coherence of our final report.

Key Takeaways and Reflection

Academic and Learning Takeaways

This project deepened my understanding of macroeconomic models and their practical relevance. Through Japan's case, I saw how the AD-AS framework operates in reality: when aggregate demand shifts leftward—as during Japan's asset bubble burst or the COVID-19 shock—a recessionary gap emerges. Without timely and coordinated fiscal and monetary responses, the economy can fall into prolonged stagnation.

Japan's experience revealed the limits of monetary policy. In a liquidity trap, interest rate cuts alone cannot restore growth; recovery requires combining monetary easing with structural reforms that enhance supply capacity. This idea lies at the heart of Abenomics.

The Japanese case also holds important lessons for China, which now faces similar challenges—including slowing growth, an ageing population, and high leverage. Sustainable development can no longer rely primarily on credit expansion or investment, but must be driven by innovation, industrial upgrading, and adaptable policy coordination.

Personal Growth and Reflection

This project strengthened both my collaborative and independent skills. I led the team's analysis and improved my R skills to visualise Japan's inflation and output trends clearly.

I learned the importance of clear roles, open communication, and time management. Using AI tools enhanced my focus on critical thinking, while highlighting that true understanding and synthesis remain human tasks.

For future improvement, I plan to standardise my data analysis workflow and develop a personal report-writing template. I also aim to strengthen my economic modelling skills by translating empirical observations into simplified theoretical frameworks—such as applying the New Keynesian IS curve to explain output gaps.